Active Surgical Population Management

An Integrated Response to the 2025 CMS Request for Information

Dr. Perrin Jones | June 16, 2025

Executive Summary

Elective and urgent surgical episodes remain one of the last major cost centers in U.S. healthcare without an integrated, data-driven management framework. Studies suggest that inpatient surgical care represents nearly 50% of hospital expenditures and 30% of overall healthcare costs. However, these estimates reflect only the care delivered during the initial hospitalization, and they fail to capture payments for expensive and common services that occur after discharge like those related to readmissions and post-acute care. With the average American undergoing nine procedures during their lifetime, a more efficient way of managing surgical care is needed.

The Help.ai Surgical Population Management (SPM) Solution bridges this gap by unifying nationwide clinical data, coordinating multi-disciplinary workflows, and aligning financial incentives across the peri-operative continuum. Initial implementations showed a 60% decrease in unnecessary and or duplicative testing yielding costs savings of over $600 per surgical patient. Other results included a significant reduction in day of surgery cancellations (>1%), fewer complications, improved patient and provider satisfaction and significant bundled-payment savings for payers and providers. Based upon our calculations, this approach will save between $4000-5000 per surgical episode of care when inpatient versus outpatient facility fee differentials, avoidance of duplicative and unnecessary testing and appropriate post-surgical disposition plans are taken into account.

Purpose & Vision

Help.ai believes every person has a chance to thrive by connecting the right resources at the right time. In the surgical domain, this translates into:

- Holistic information access straight from EHRs—not patient recall.
- Semi-automated clinical protocols that identify risks early.
- Rational bundled-payment distribution that rewards value, not volume.

Market Challenge

- Surgical care consumes ~30% of total healthcare spend, yet pre-operative evaluations are often redundant and fragmented.

- Patients shuffle between PCPs, specialists, and hospitals with no single source of accurate clinical data regarding comorbidities, labs, or social drivers.
- Fee-for-service incentives misalign stakeholders; incur avoidable cancellations and re-admissions while inflating costs.

The Solution

1: Unified Health Data Fabric

Help.ai provides a unified health data fabric that connects clinical data from >90 % of U.S. facilities and ~300 M longitudinal records in minutes, unifying CCDAs into a FHIR R5 data lake without patient effort.

2: Clinical Algorithms:

Surgery Readiness: Help.ai leverages clinical algorithms to ensure each patient is ready for surgery.

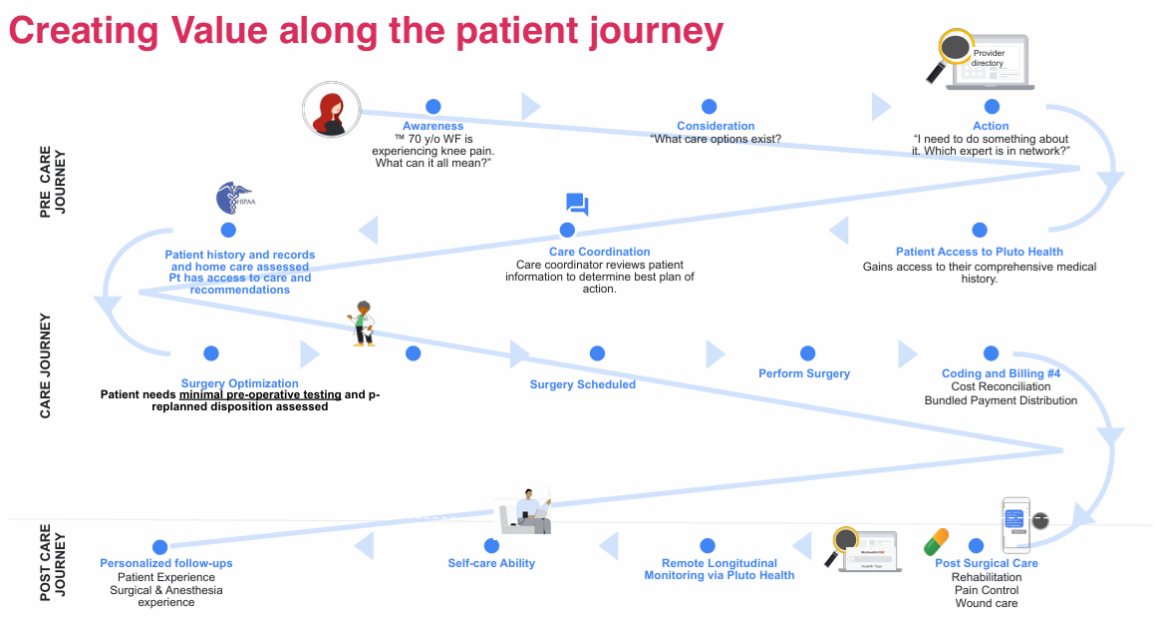
Site of Service: Help.ai algorithms determine the best site of service for a surgery to maximize clinical outcomes and reduce costs.

Clinical Pathways: Help.ai algorithms determine what tests are needed to ensure the patient has a successful surgery as well as how to manage any comorbidities that the patient may have.

3: Surgical Population Management Workflow

Care Journey

Help.ai maps the full patient journey—from awareness of knee pain to post-surgical rehab—embedding decision points for primary care, specialists, anesthesia, and billing.



Value Proposition

Clinical & Financial Outcomes

- Improved clinical quality through standardized pre-op evaluation.
- Lower costs via reducing unnecessary and duplicative preoperative testing.
- Lower costs through appropriate site of surgical service (i.e. inpatient v. outpatient) determination.
- Lower costs via appropriate disposition planning prior to day of surgery.
- Lower costs via aligned incentives and data sharing between PCPs, specialists, hospitals, and payers.

Stakeholder Benefits

- Patients: Will be provided with one portal housing their processed clinical data, care gap analysis and educational resources for their intended procedure.
- Providers: Improve overall efficiency, satisfaction and clinical care as well as increasing their bundled-payment bonus.
- Payers: Transparent cost, lower total spend, data for risk adjustment.

Testimonials & Early Feedback

"Clinical efficiency has improved considerably since we came on board. The new patient flow lets me increase productivity." — Participating Surgeon

Patients echo this sentiment, citing a more thorough evaluation and confidence knowing "information from all my doctors—even my cardiologist 100 miles away—was collected."

Conclusion

Health.ai active SPM Solution delivers the right data, at the right time, to the right team—turning surgical episodes into coordinated, value-driven care journeys. By combining nationwide data unification with incentive-aligned payment models, health systems can achieve measurable quality gains, cost savings, and patient satisfaction.

Contact

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